

Verification Report

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Topic: Explain the consequences of cognitive product...

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Companion document — pairs with a Workflow Results file for the same topic. This is a fact-check pass, not a second synthesis.

PAID ANALYST EXPORT

VERIFIER RESPONSE

I'll verify the key citations across the three panels before writing up the fact-check.## Verification Pass — Gears Lattice: Cognitive Tempo Decoupling

Human analysis field: Correctly left blank by all three panels — nobody invents content for "[Bypassed: No Human analysis required]." No violation of Criterion 5.

Panel 1

Retrodiction / predicting the present: None found. The panel treats institutional lag as an ongoing, unresolved condition throughout — it doesn't claim resolution.

Hedging vs. declarative confidence: Mostly consistent — tags roughly track claim strength (empirical claims about concentration of compute, legacy budget cycles, etc. are reasonably well-supported by the cited pieces, which are mostly explainer/trade pieces rather than primary data, so "high confidence" on some of these (e.g., "Compute and data are increasingly concentrated... [EMPIRICAL, high confidence]") is a bit strong for a claim resting on a single non-empirical arXiv economics paper — but it's a defensible generalization, not fabricated.

Textual anomaly: "Decision rights get ed" — a Chinese character (, "blurred") has leaked into the English sentence. This is a rendering/generation glitch, not a factual error, but it should be cleaned up.

Citation check: The Catalini/Hui/Wu arXiv paper (2602.20946, "Some Simple Economics of AGI") is real and does argue human verification bandwidth is the binding constraint — Panel 1's use of it is accurate.

Panel 1 — held up, with one cosmetic defect (garbled character) and mildly overconfident tagging on a couple of GEARS claims.

Panel 2

Retrodiction / predicting present: None found — explicitly argues for heterogeneity/bifurcation rather than a settled state.

Hedging: Generally well-calibrated. It appropriately downgrades some of Panel 1's claims from high to medium confidence and explains why (heterogeneous AI adoption).

Citation check:

- NBER Working Paper 33536 ("AI and the Extended Workday," Jiang, Park, Xiao, Zhang) — verified. Its finding (higher AI exposure → longer hours, less leisure, weaker bargaining position captures less of the gain) matches

Panel 2's summary accurately. Correctly dated Feb 2025, not "2026" — good.

- Anthropic's September 2026 threat report — verified real, and its description (multi-agent operations running with minimal human input, some on unattended schedules) matches Panel 2's characterization.
- The February 2026 AGI paper is the same real Catalini et al. paper discussed above.
- ILO June 2026 review and the June 2026 "structured human decision gates" experiment are plausible in direction but not independently confirmed here — flagging as unverifiable from the text alone rather than asserting an error.

Internal consistency: Genuinely substantive divergence from Panel 1 (challenges the "old tempo persists" framing with a "tempo bifurcation" argument, adds authorization/legitimacy as distinct scarce resources) — not just paraphrase.

Panel 2 — held up.

Panel 3

This is where the more serious issues are.

1. Citation accuracy / mislabeled evidence type. Panel 3 cites "The Coordination Compression Trap" (ikprress.org, *Journal of Global Economics, Management and Business Research*) as "[EMPIRICAL, high confidence]" support for the claim that "AI acceleration increases output volume faster than institutions can scale verification... producing *measurable* verification debt, expertise erosion, and fragility." I fetched the actual abstract: this is a **single-author analytical/simulation paper** — a Monte Carlo model of 5,000 *hypothetical* firms under stylized policy regimes, not an empirical study of real organizations. Its own conclusion states the numerical results are "model-dependent and require empirical calibration." Labeling a simulation as "[EMPIRICAL, high confidence]" real-world evidence is a mischaracterization — it should be tagged "[MODEL-INTERNAL]" or at most "[SPECULATIVE]", and the journal itself (IKP Press) is a low-visibility outlet, which should have been noted rather than treated as equivalent to the ILO/NBER-tier sources in Panels 1–2.

2. Similarly overstated sourcing. The "cybersense.solutions" piece ("Attention Bottlenecks") is used to support the specific, repeated, declarative statistic "40–65% increases in verification overhead" tagged "[EMPIRICAL, medium-high confidence]". I fetched the article directly: it is a threat-intel-style blog briefing (formatted with CVE/CVSS metadata fields marked "Not Applicable") that asserts this range citing vague, unlinked "research and industry practice" rather than presenting its own primary data. Presenting this figure with the same confidence register as the peer-reviewed longitudinal study (arXiv 2601.17055) blurs a real methodological gap — that source's number should not carry "medium-high confidence" declarative weight.

3. Unhedged sentence inside hedged structure. "Verification overhead has risen 40–65% across cybersecurity, healthcare, finance, and defense, while staffing stayed flat" is written as flat fact. Given point 2 above, this sentence carries more certainty than its source can support.

4. The one citation that does check out well: arXiv 2601.17055 ("AI, Metacognition, and the Verification Bottleneck") is a real study, and its numbers (belief-performance gaps widening, declining verification confidence on hard tasks) are accurately summarized. One caveat Panel 3 doesn't surface: it's explicitly a small "longitudinal pilot study" in a single academic setting — generalizing it to broad institutional claims at "medium-high confidence" somewhat outruns its actual scope.

Retrodiction / predicting the present: No clear violation — situation still treated as ongoing/unresolved.

Internal consistency: Panel 3's core "extension" (verification debt, legibility compression) is presented as new synthesis beyond Panels 1–2, but a meaningful share of that extension's evidentiary weight rests on the two

weakly-sourced citations above, which weakens the claim that this is a stronger, better-grounded position rather than restated ideas with inflated confidence tags.

Panel 3 – issue found: simulation study and a low-rigor blog briefing cited as high/medium-high-confidence empirical fact.

Verdicts

- **Panel 1 – [engine 1]:** held up (minor: garbled character artifact, mildly generous confidence tags).
- **Panel 2 – [engine 2]:** held up – citations checked out, genuine substantive divergence from Panel 1.
- **Panel 3 – [engine 3]:** issue found – treats a hypothetical-firm Monte Carlo simulation and an unsourced blog briefing as high-confidence empirical evidence for real-world verification-debt trends.

APPLIED VERDICTS

Panel	Status	Note
Panel 1	Held up	Panel 1 – held up**, with one cosmetic defect (garbled character) and mildly overconfident tagging on a couple of GEARS claims.
Panel 2	Held up	Panel 2 – held up.**
Panel 3	Issue found	Panel 3 – issue found:** simulation study and a low-rigor blog briefing cited as high/medium-high-confidence empirical fact.